RammGrind -- Industrial Metal Bass (Rammstein Style)

Rebuild 2026-09-25: AMP/CAB replaced by the BrightSVT snaptone (slot 55). The GP-5's Bass OD stays as the main grind stage.
Earlier builds: 2026-09-08 used a Darkglass Alpha Omega NAM. 2026-09-18 went back to GP-5 AMP + IR while NAMs were off for the Valeton N->S volume issue. Same style target and CTL concept across all builds.

Style reference

This patch chases Oliver "Ollie" Riedel's Rammstein bass tone.

Not a "bass tone" in the usual sense.
It's a distorted low-end doubling of the guitar riff, built to be one wall of sound, not a separate instrument.
Tight, percussive, mid-forward, buzzsaw-grindy -- not boomy, not scooped.

Same territory: Paul Barker (Ministry), Jeordie White / Twiggy Ramirez (Marilyn Manson) -- industrial and industrial-adjacent metal bassists who treat the bass as a distortion source that reinforces the guitar wall, not a low-end cushion under it.

Two CTL states cover the dynamic range this style actually uses:
verse/groove sections stay controlled and tight, choruses and breakdown hits get pushed harder.
Rammstein's mix rarely goes "clean" -- even the restrained sections carry grit. Only the amount of push changes.

GP-5 module chain

Module order is fixed: NR, PRE, DST, AMP, CAB, EQ, MOD, DLY, RVB.

NR -- Gate
- THRE: 42
- Always on. Industrial rhythm playing is staccato and palm-muted hard. A tight gate keeps the mutes dead silent between hits instead of smearing into a wash of fuzz noise.

PRE -- Micro Boost
- Gain: 70
- CTL switch. Off at rest, engaged on CTL press.
- CTL off: leaner grind -- DST alone drives the tone. Covers verses and groove sections.
- CTL on: extra clean gain shoved into the DST stage for choruses, breakdowns, and big unison hits -- thickens and compresses the distortion without changing its color.

DST -- Bass OD (loads on; MIDI toggle, see MIDI toggles)
- Gain: 78
- Blend: 70
- VOL: 60
- Bass: 45

- Treble: 68
- Always on. This is the core of the patch -- modeled on the Boss ODB-3, a real metal-bass-distortion staple. High Gain gets the buzzsaw edge. Blend at 70 keeps it mostly wet but doesn't fully drown the dry fundamental -- that's what keeps note definition intact under heavy distortion instead of collapsing into undifferentiated fuzz. Bass rolled back to 45 on the pedal itself so the low end doesn't get flabby before it hits the amp stage -- let the snaptone supply the low end, DST supplies the grind.

AMP/CAB -- NAM SnapTone, slot 55: BrightSVT (always on)
- Built from the `SVT SANS BRIGHT DRIVE (SVT-CL)` NAM and the Hartke410 IR, combined into one snaptone.
- Real Ampeg SVT-CL with the bright drive setting, into the aluminum-cone Hartke410 IR.
- Rammstein bass is a bright, driven doubling of the guitar riff. Bright SVT drive and Hartke clank.
- Gain: 58, VOL: 60, Bass: 50, Middle: 65, Treble: 62
- Gain 58: noticeably over default. This part wants more push than the other BrightSVT patches.
- Bass 50: flat.
- Middle 65: more midrange.
- Treble 62: more top end.
- VOL 60: the level Michael set for this snaptone in the 2026-10-02 VOL audit. Trim here if the patch jumps in level against your others.
- Same in both CTL states. AMP and CAB are off in the `.prst`, so nothing stacks on the capture. The N->S block calls slot 55 directly.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1
- 33Hz: -8
- 150Hz: -6
- 600Hz: +12
- 2kHz: +10
- 8kHz: +6
- VOL: 55
- Always on.
- Sub (33Hz) and low-mid boom (150Hz) both cut -- this style has zero interest in sub-bass weight, that just competes with the kick and turns the wall to mud. 600Hz and 2kHz both pushed hard -- that's the grinding midrange bite and pick/finger attack that lets the bass cut through the guitar wall on a system that can't reproduce much below 80Hz live. 8kHz nudged up for string-noise edge/buzz on top.

MOD / DLY / RVB -- Off
- No modulation, no delay, no reverb.
- This style is dry and direct by design -- a chorus or delay would soften the attack and blur the tightness the whole patch is built around. Unchanged from the original build.

MIDI toggles

MIDI = True (added 2026-10-12). With no MIDI controller connected, the patch loads and plays exactly as

before: CTL and the board work the same. MIDI adds single-block toggles on top.

On MIDI: DST (Bass OD), MIDI-only, loads on.

Sounds:

- **Base grind** (default). CTL off.
- **Lean grind.** MIDI DST off. The Stylish Fuzz and Tidal Wave keep grinding, but without the Bass OD layer. A lower level of push for quieter verses. Rammstein rarely goes clean, so this stays gritty, just less dense.
- **Pushed** (CTL on). Micro Boost into the Bass OD for choruses and breakdowns.
- Don't combine Lean grind with CTL on: the Micro Boost then has no Bass OD to push.

Full pedalboard (signal chain order)

The `.prst` only encodes the GP-5's own 9 modules plus the NAM. Everything below is manual -- set it on the pedals themselves; it's not in the file.

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- bypassed by default

- -2OCT: 0, -OCT: 20, +OCT: 0, +2OCT: 0, Dry: 100
- Footswitch off for the main tone -- the 5-string's low B already covers the fundamental range this style needs, and a sub-octave voice under an already-distorted signal turns to mud fast.
- Optional engage: stomp on for big stadium-ending "wall" hits (the "Sonne" / "Mein Herz Brennt" outro-swell move) -- the modest -OCT level at 20 adds weight without swallowing the note.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- engaged

- COMP: 65
- TONE: 55
- LEVEL: 55
- Mode: TREBLE
- Always on. Squashes pick/finger attack into a consistent, aggressive, always-the-same-level groove -- industrial rhythm parts need to sound machine-tight, not human-dynamic. TREBLE mode keeps attack articulate before it hits two more gain stages downstream.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- engaged

- Sustain: 55
- Treble: 60
- Bass: 35
- Volume: 55
- Always on. This is half of the signature grind -- stacking a fuzz stage ahead of the Tidal Wave's own drive and the GP-5's Bass OD is what gets the layered, buzzsaw-dense distortion instead of one clean gain stage doing all the work. Sustain kept moderate (not maxed) -- full Sustain gets gated and splattery, which reads as sloppy, not industrial-tight. Bass rolled back on the pedal itself for the same reason as the DST stage: keep the low end controlled downstream, not flubby at the source.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- engaged

- Drive: 70

- Blend: 65
- Presence: 60
- Level: 60
- Treble: 60
- Middle: 65
- Bass: 50
- Mid-Frequency: 1000Hz
- Bass-Shift: 80Hz
- Cab-Sim (DI out): On
- Ground Lift: Off (engage only if hum shows up on the DI feed)
- Always on -- this is the main preamp/drive stage of the whole chain. Blend at 65 keeps it mostly-driven but not fully wet, same note-definition logic as the DST stage. Mid-Frequency at 1000Hz over 500Hz -- this style wants pick/finger attack and cut-through, not round low-mid body. Bass-Shift at 80Hz tightens the low end so it doesn't stack mud on top of everything already piled up from the fuzz and DST stages before it.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- bypassed
- Mode: Vintage, Width/Depth/Rate: low (default light-chorus values)
- Footswitch off. This style is dry and direct -- no chorus anywhere in the signal. Left dialed to safe defaults in case a future patch wants it, but it stays off here.

6. Valeton GP-5
- Settings as documented above, including the BrightSVT snaptone in slot 55.

When to engage what

- **Base tone (CTL off):** Gate, Comp, Fuzz, Tidal Wave, Bass OD, BrightSVT snaptone, EQ -- everything on except the PRE boost and the octave. This is the sound for the whole song, verses included. It's already distorted and aggressive at rest -- that's the point.
- **CTL on:** Punch in for choruses, big unison stabs, and breakdown hits -- pushes the Bass OD harder via the Micro Boost for a thicker, more compressed wall.
- **Octave stomp:** Reserve for song-ending swells/outros only -- not a default-on effect.